

L6: Lesson Summary



This lesson introduced you to a toolbox of network analysis that you can use any time you want to identify the most important nodes or edges of the network, to rank nodes or edges in terms of importance, or to identify the most important groups of nodes.

The collection of centrality metrics and core-group detection algorithms we reviewed is not comprehensive of course. You can find many more such metrics in the literature, depending on the specific notion of *importance* in the problem you study. In some cases, you may even need to define your

own metric.

In practice, applying a wide collection of centrality metrics and core-group detection algorithms is one of the first steps we perform whenever we are given a new network dataset. Such a preliminary analysis helps to identify the nodes or edges that *stand out* in the network, at least according to one of these metrics.